



# Industry News

## Brazil witnesses world's largest desktop Linux deployment

Useful and ThinNetworks have been selected to supply 3,56,800 virtualised desktops to schools in all of Brazil's 5,560 municipalities. According to the duo, it is a historical achievement of being the world's largest ever virtual desktop deployment; the world's largest ever desktop Linux deployment; and a new record for low-cost PCs -- with the PCs sharing hardware and the software, hence costing less than \$50 per seat.

"Useful is very happy to have been selected to participate in this historic opportunity to help millions of children get the computer education they need in a sustainable way," said Tim Griffin, president, Useful.

In combination with hardware from ThinNetworks, Useful Multiplier is also the lowest-cost desktop virtualisation solution in the market. Useful offers the features of a full PC, including high performance video for less than \$50 per additional seat in large deployments (not including monitors and keyboards), and uses standard PC hardware including additional low-cost video cards and USB/2-way-audio hubs from ThinNetworks.

"This deployment alone saves more than 170,000 tons of CO2 emissions annually, the same as taking 28,000 cars off the road, or planting 41,000 acres of trees," said Sean Rousseau, marketing manager, Useful. "Turning 1 computer into 10 reduces computer hardware waste by up to 80 per cent, further decreasing its environmental footprint."

The project comprises three phases, the first of which consist of 18,750 workstations in rural schools that have already been installed and are in operation.



## Sun launches 'Open Innovation Portal'

Reaffirming its commitment to open source as a catalyst to encourage innovation in India, Sun Microsystems has launched the Open Innovation Portal at the Centre for Excellence in e-governance, Department of Management Studies, IIT Delhi with JNU and Knowledge Commons as collaborators.

The portal [[www.innovationcommons.org](http://www.innovationcommons.org)] was launched by Joe Hartley, Sun's VP for Global Education, Government and Healthcare, and Prof'S. S.

Yadav, head of the Department of Management Studies, IIT Delhi. The objective behind the launch is to foster the development of participative innovation in society, and to help transition the economy into an innovation economy. The portal will allow innovators from the science and student community and from all walks of life to publish their innovations with no IPR encumbrances, for the whole world to benefit. It will also help others to add to any open innovation that has been published online, thus enabling the process of participative innovation.

Speaking at the inauguration, Hartley said, "The Innovation Portal therefore allows for collaboration between members of a society

to foster innovation. This is in line with Sun's vision of the Participation Age in which, the company believes, the world has

entered a new era where dramatically lowered barriers to entry, plummeting device prices, and near-universal connectivity are driving a new round of network participation."



## Wind River becomes LiMo's systems integrator

LiMo Foundation has selected Wind River, a device software optimisation (DSO) company, as the systems integrator to deliver the common infrastructure, tools, testing and integration services for the LiMo platform. A board member of LiMo Foundation, Wind River will now provide technology and services to combine, harden and validate code contributions of LiMo members through a Common Working Environment (CWE).

"As the mobile industry now breaks out of its traditional, controlled development environments and embraces collaborative approaches that unlock innovation, operators and device manufacturers are turning to vendors they can trust to guide them through the evolving mobile software landscape," said Morgan Gillis, executive director, LiMo Foundation. "Through its selection of Wind River as a company with a legacy of world-class embedded software, LiMo expects to be able to accelerate its goal of reducing Linux fragmentation while intensifying platform development through the rapid adoption of member contributions."

In addition to the integration of member code, Wind River expects to enhance the efficiency of the contribution process for members through collaboration tools and enhanced processes. This will become increasingly important as more strategic contributions require integration into LiMo reference platforms.